

lumber.bid

Where the vertical actually stands, and what to build next. Every figure below was executed against production on 6 September 2026.

The rails are finished. The market has not started.

Ten days of clean analytics show **38 pageviews**. Downstream of them, every number that matters is zero: no listing has ever existed, no lot has ever been auctioned, no lead has ever been captured, no order has ever been placed. That is not a failure of the build — the capture, the escrow and the instrumentation are all there and have simply never fired. It is the absence of a first seller.

1. What is built

Three weeks of work landed in production and all of it is live. Nothing in this table is waiting on engineering.

Capability	State	Where it lives
Sealed-bid auction rails	Live in prod	migration 20260821003609
Log value estimator	Live , photo + manual	lumber.bid/estimate
Fixed-price seller walk	Live , one question per screen	timber.bid/lumber/sell
AI drafting from photos	Live , vision only, never prices	draft-slab-listing
Bulk lumber (NHLA, MBF)	Live	migration 20260906020000
Lead capture and claim flow	Live , single-use token by email	claim_slab_lead()
Escrow, fees, payouts	Live , shared with timber.bid	utils/fees.ts
First-party analytics	Live , founder traffic excluded	site/metrics.js

2. What it has produced

Measure	All time	Note
Pageviews	38	28 Aug - 6 Sep; 32 home, 6 estimate, 1 leaderboard
Outbound clicks to the app	1	the only funnel event ever recorded
Raw-timber listings, ever	0	the lot board has never held a lot
Lumber auctions, ever	0	6 auctions exist; all firewood, none live
Saved log estimates	0	6 people opened /estimate; nothing persisted

Seller leads captured	0	slab_seller_leads is empty
Waitlist signups from lumber.bid	0	the form works; nobody has used it
Lumber orders / revenue	0	platform-wide lifetime GMV is \$67.08

Roughly four visits a day, and nothing downstream. The honest reading is that lumber.bid has not yet been shown to anyone who mills or sells wood.

3. What was actually wrong

Finding 1 — the front door never offered the working path

The homepage's entire sell story was the sealed-bid auction, and both of its calls to action pointed at /lumber/post and the lot board. That auction has had **zero lots in its lifetime**. The fixed-price seller walk — a photo, a price, a phone number, with the photos drafting the rest — was live and **not linked from lumber.bid at all**.

Fixed today. The sell section now leads with milled wood and carries the primary button to /lumber/sell. The auction keeps its pitch, which is honest and right for standing timber, and loses the primary button — a primary button should point at something a visitor can finish.

Finding 2 — the manual calculator recorded nothing

Photo mode was already thoroughly beacons: request, return, rejection, failure, each photo added, each correction confirmed. The manual calculator had none of it. A visitor could set a species and a diameter, read a real value band and leave, and production could not tell that apart from never opening the page.

Fixed today. One estimate_shown event per visit, carrying whether the log came out as lumber or as firewood. It does not fire for the walnut default that renders on load — counting that would answer “did the page load”, which the pageview already answers.

Correction to the first draft of this page

An earlier version said the estimator captured nothing and that only two events existed. Both were wrong, and wrong in the same way: they were read from what has FIRED in production rather than from what is built. The email ask, the estimate-log confirm path that attaches an address to the log it is about, and seven funnel beacons were all already there. They have never fired because six people have opened /estimate and none of them finished. The headline was also already the appraisal rather than the auction, refocused on 27 August. Only the two findings above survived checking, and both are now closed.

4. The next phase

The instinct after three weeks of building is to build more. The numbers say the opposite: the constraint is not capability, it is that nobody has been asked.

Phase A — make the built thing reachable and measurable (done)

Change	Why	State
Homepage leads with /lumber/sell	The working flow was unreachable from the front door	Shipped
estimate_shown on the manual calculator	The only unmeasured path on the site	Shipped
Estimator capture step	Already built: the email ask and the confirm path both exist	Already there
Headline is the appraisal, not the auction	Already done on 27 August	Already there

Phase B — get one seller, by hand (the real work)

Nothing on the site fixes a supply cold start. The mill list and the outreach draft are already written and sitting in the private repo, unused. Phase B is sending them: seventeen mills, by hand, from the outreach domain, offering to list their wood for them from photographs they text over. The first listing does not have to be self-serve. It has to exist.

One caution worth stating plainly. The platform has sent 28,263 cold emails and holds \$67.08 of lifetime revenue. More volume is not the lever; a specific ask to a specific mill is.

Phase C — only after a real close

The photo-grid homepage, the leaderboard promotion, the freight quote at checkout and the buyer side all wait on one event: a lot that closes with competing bids. Building them earlier means shipping empty shelves, which is the mistake this repo already has a written rule against.

What to watch first

estimate_shown is now the number that decides whether /estimate deserves more traffic, and its route field says whether visitors are bringing real sawlogs or firewood. If the next handful of visits produce no estimate_shown at all, the six recorded visits were crawlers and Phase B is the only thing that matters.

Sources: production database, 6 September 2026 (site_events, listings, slab_seller_leads, orders, log_estimates, campaign_performance); lumberbid-v1 at HEAD; timberbid-v1 at HEAD. Platform-wide findings, including an open P0 on schema default privileges, are in docs/AUDIT_2026-09-06_PLATFORM.md.